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Wireless standard	Solutions
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Wider bandwidths	➤ NI's PXle-5673E 6.6GHz RF vector signal generators ➤ Anritsu's MG3700A vector signal generator ➤ R&S SMU200A and SGS100A signal generators
MIMO (multiple input/multiple output)	➤ Sciencetech's NB100C2 series DSO ➤ ZTEC's ZT8651 PXI/PXIe 6GHz VSA and ZProtocol WLAN ➤ Agilent 89600 VSA software
Zigbee	➤ Agilent N4010A-102 for Zigbee ➤ NI's PXI-5660 2.7GHz RF vector signal analyser ➤ Micronics MSA500 hand-held signal analyser (marketed by Sciencetech)
RFID	➤ Sirit's TVS-1000, TVS-2500R and TVS-150 ➤ Tescom's TC-2600A RFID tester ➤ Agilent's T3121S NFC R/D test system
GPS	➤ NI's GPS simulator PXI RF test system for GPS receiver test ➤ Agilent's GPS-101 global positioning simulator ➤ CAST Navigation's CAST-SGX GPS satellite simulator
802.11ac	➤ NI's PXle-5644R and WLAN analysis toolkit ➤ Agilent's N5182B MXG, with Signal Studio software ➤ Aeroflex' PXI 3036 13GHz RF digitiser

distortion, quadrature error, IQ errors and interference. Most of these tests were simulated due to the lack of hardware."

Hire explains, "With a low fixed broadband penetration of approximately nine per cent of households, mobile broadband is well-positioned to become the main means of Internet access for many Indians. This is already starting with 3G, and LTE—both TDD and FDD—will further enhance access to the Internet in the coming years."

"In order to meet the capacity demands there will be a shift away from centrally-managed networks based on macro base stations to heterogeneous networks (HetNets) that comprise a mix of home-based femtocells, small cells (microcells and picocells) for hotspot and in-building coverage, and traditional macrocells. Instead of relying on centrally planned networks, with eNB parameters optimised using large volumes of drive test data, base stations will need to be designed to adapt to the RF conditions in their own environment and change dynamically," he adds.

Chaitanya Chakravarty, application engineer, Agilent Technologies India Pvt Ltd, adds, "Recently, the demand for even higher data rates on WLAN technologies

has expanded applications to wireless high definition video streaming to TV, multimedia players, video cameras, PCs, smartphones, and tablets. IEEE 802.11ac aims at a minimum 500Mbps data rate and up to around 6.93 Gbps with various enhanced technologies, including wider channel bandwidth up to 160 MHz, and higher modulation up to 256 QAM. Furthermore, MIMO plays an important role in achieving very high throughput 802.11ac with up to 8-channel beam-forming and multi-user MIMO technologies."

Mohan Kamam, principal system architect, Posegde Technologies India Pvt Ltd, opines, "As 802.11ac chipsets became widely available, it is expected to penetrate mobile handsets. Due to power constraints on mobile handsets, these might initially support only 1x1 80MHz operation. Most aps will support at least 80MHz BW and at least three transmitter and receiver chains enabling very high throughputs. To reduce the demands for costly licensed spectrum, we will also see data off-loading by the cellular network operators to wireless LANs wherever access points are available." ●

The author is a tech correspondent at EYF Bengaluru